



THE GAME VISION

In 'Helsing's Revolver', you follow and kill the invading vampires as a cowboy to save the world from its gothic demise. Increase your skill by strategizing with weapons, items and cigarettes to become the ultimate force in this roguelike bump-attack battler.

Genre

The game is a rogue-like, dungeon crawler, with turn-based combat and a focus on item builds. It is inspired by games like 'He is coming' and 'Darkest Dungeon'.



GAMEPLAY
'He is coming'
'Shroom and Gloom'



CONTENT AND VIBE
'Loop Hero'
'Jojo's Bizarre Adventure'



ARTSTYLE
'Darkest Dungeon'
'Helsing'

Game Pillars

- **Rogue-like + deckbuilding** - Combines smooth and casual gameplay with strategic item builds. Creates a new experience every time you play.
- **Fun vs dark serious** - Funny and crazy characters/setting but they take themselves very seriously.
- **Smooth user experience** - smooth and simple inputs, easy to play with just one hand on Computer and on Mobile, put away the phone or tab out at any moment and don't miss something.
- **One scene one camera** - Everything happens in the same scene, no extra combat screen or loading screen between map and gameplay.

Key Features

- Fight invading vampires in a wild west setting
- Optimize your chances of slaying the vampires by exploiting weapon and item synergies
- Fulfill your ultimate rogue-like bump-battle power fantasy
- Move along the curvature of the planet and choose your path strategically

Unique Selling points

Helsing's Revolver stands out through its exciting fantasy and its interesting art style.

- **Dark Wild West Showdown** - The art and style of the game support the fantasy of a Showdown moment against a vampire with a gun
- **One screen Gameplay** - Fighting, item build, world map. All Gameplay is happening in one scene on screen.
- **Dark Fantasy Cartoon style** - Dark and weird vibes but everyone and everything has a gun, a cowboy hat or boots.
- **Vampires as Cowboys** - Hunt down gothic vampires and a wild west setting



Vampire shrimp with gun

Team



Christoph Vögele



Annika Gerber



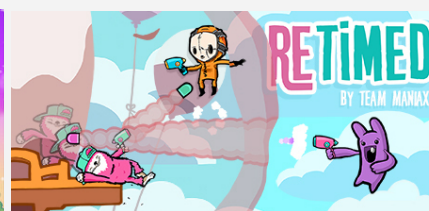
Nils Leuzinger

Our team consists of Old Cake Factory (Annika Gerber, Christoph Vögele) and Nils Leuzinger. We have banded together for the Swiss Game Hub Bootcamp and set out to create a fun prototype. We ended up creating two prototypes in the bootcamp, and this is one of them. The project lead for Helsing's Revolver lies with Old Cake Factory.

Old Cake Factory is known for their previous roguelike-cooking madness success Goblin Sushi. They founded their studio in December 2025. Their studio's goal is to release small games with fun narratives, with tight game loops. And in their productions they focus on quick iteration and rapid market validation. The goal is to be a long-lasting force in the Swiss Games Industry.

And Nils is a well established developer in the Swiss game dev community and is known for his fun itch.io prototypes, organizing the monthly Godotreff at the Swiss Game Hub and his work on the "Farmer Was Replaced: The Miner Was Replaced" DLC, that is set to launch in September.

Games we've worked on

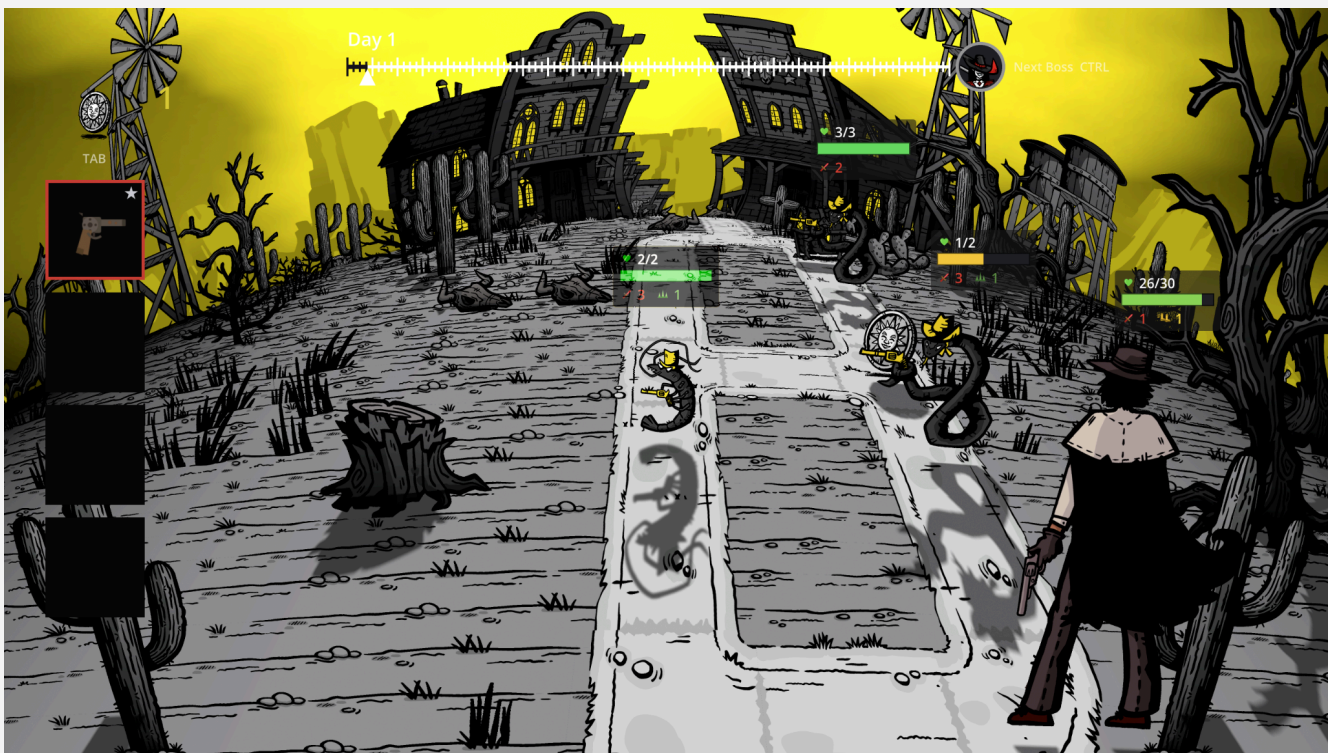


Gameplay

Helsing's Revolver combines smooth and casual gameplay with strategic item builds. Choose your items and weapons wisely and adjust your build according to the enemies you're fighting. Play with full focus on your main computer screen, have it open as second screen entertainment or play casually on the bus.

Decide which enemy you want to face and what path you want to take

The game is about the strategic decisions you take at each intersection, do you choose to fight the easier enemy and get a coin, or fight the harder enemy and get the option to open a chest? And sometimes you do not yet know what your reward is, but will the reward outweigh the risk? Also, every decision is theoretically predictable, because the stats of your character and the stats of the enemy are known, so you can



A choice between fighting a shrimp and getting no loot or fighting the snake to get a coin

Choose your items and weapons strategically

In Helsing's Revolver items are a big part of your decisions. The items are designed to help you against certain enemies and bosses and to fulfill the player's power fantasies. You can maximize your armor and tank all the enemies or turn into a high attack low health glass cannon, but beware certain enemies can counter you and you need to choose strategically.

The items have stats like Armor, Attack, Speed, Thorns, Freeze and much more.

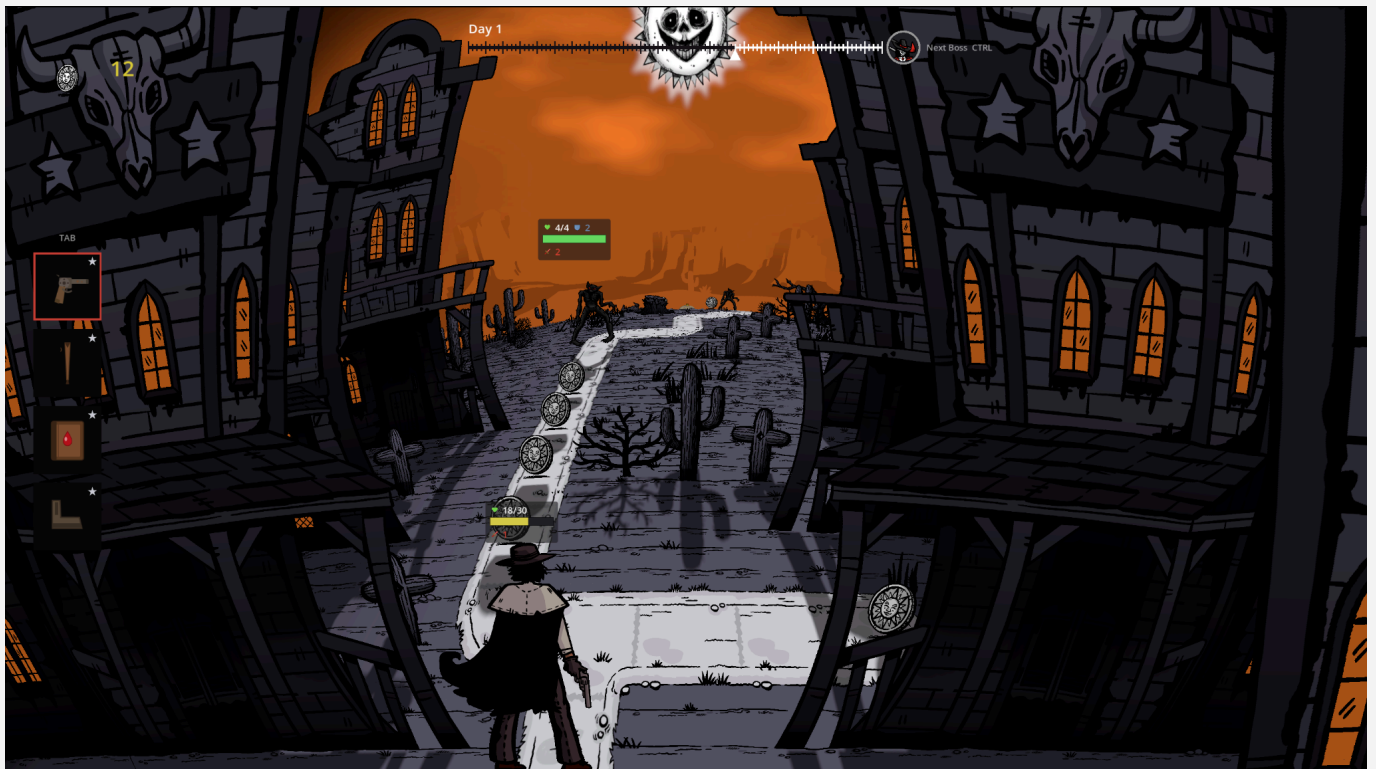
- Attack increases your damage on hit, making you a stronger opponent
- Armor absorbs incoming damage, shielding your precious health
- Thorns reflect incoming damage, helping you against high damage enemies.
- ...



Chest Item Selection with three items to choose from.

Progress through the day and get ready for the nighttime creeping in

As the day progresses, the sun drops and the sky turns redder and the next boss is coming in closer and closer. The windows get tinted more red and the shadows are longer. Once the sun has fully set you have to face the vampire boss. If you defeat the boss you can go to the next day, if you lose you have to restart and try again.



The world gets more red, the more the sun sets.

Duel the Vampire boss that invaded your town

At any point in the game, you can see the next bosses abilities and their stats. Depending on that you may have to fully change your build to win the next boss.

Does the next boss ignore your armor? Then maximize damage without armor. Have you been building for speed but the next boss gains extra health when you are faster than it? Then drop your speed and get some armor or thorns or freeze!



Facing the boss after every day is the ultimate challenge

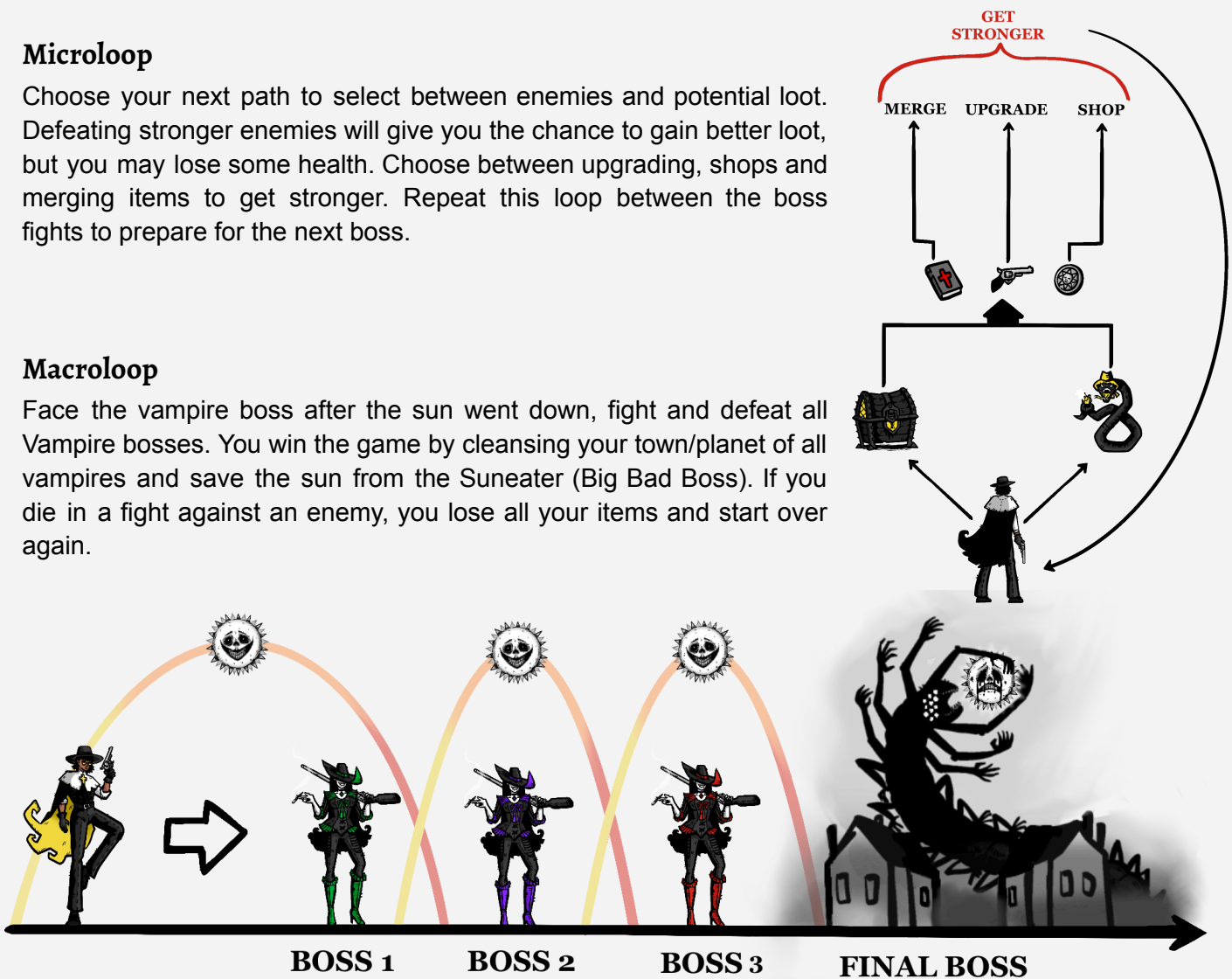
Gameplay Loops

Microloop

Choose your next path to select between enemies and potential loot. Defeating stronger enemies will give you the chance to gain better loot, but you may lose some health. Choose between upgrading, shops and merging items to get stronger. Repeat this loop between the boss fights to prepare for the next boss.

Macroloop

Face the vampire boss after the sun went down, fight and defeat all Vampire bosses. You win the game by cleansing your town/planet of all vampires and save the sun from the Suneater (Big Bad Boss). If you die in a fight against an enemy, you lose all your items and start over again.



Story

The Story of the game will mainly be told over world building and not direct dialogue. So for example the Vampire bosses will speak with you the first time you meet them and the shopkeeper has different phrases where they can give the player more insights into the world. Additionally, we will add a small intro sequence to set up the story/fantasy of the game.

Intro could be something like this:

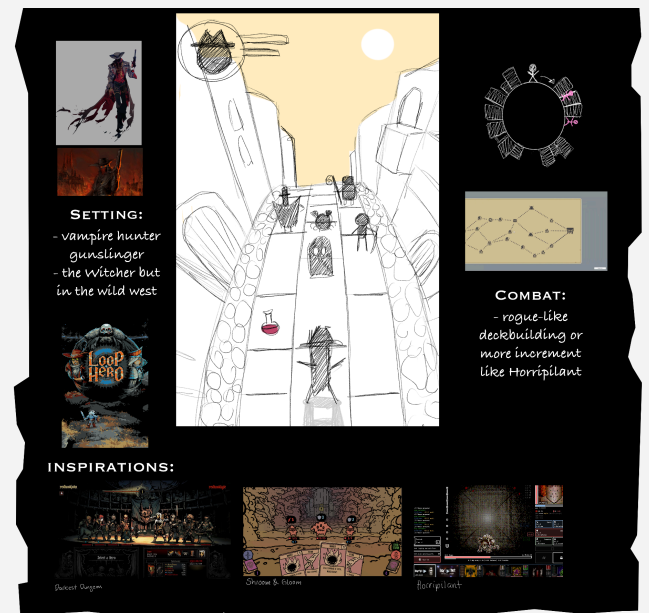
20 years ago these blood sucking aliens appeared with their space vessels in the sky. They gave us technology in trade of land to build their houses and churches. But they keep breaching the agreements, invading our land, killing and corrupting animals and peoples. The sun has begun to change and sometimes when it's dark I think I see some sort of big Shadow winding between the stars. I've found my granddad's revolver, which he used to hunt down evil spirits. Way before the aliens got here, but I'm confident I can kill some bloodsuckers with it. And if I die, I know I gave everything in the fight for the freedom of my people.

Art

The art style of this game is inspired by games like darkest dungeon and mangas like “Hellsing” or “Vampire Hunter D”.

We went through different iterations to find the right Art style one that conveys the vibe we are going for. The first few iterations looked beautiful but also very boring. Until we decided to embrace this weird and campy vibe.

Furthermore, this art style allows us to create assets faster and gives us more flexibility in adjusting colors and vibe.



first idea sketch



Mockups

Production

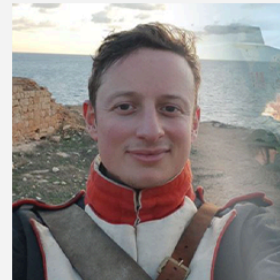
The first prototype of 'Helsing's Revolver' was developed in the Swiss Game Hub Bootcamp under the mentoring of Thomas Gervraud, Philomena Schwab and Maxim Munnig Schmidt. The Bootcamp is a two-month program that guides participants through different evaluation phases to find a market-ready project. The goal of the bootcamp is to develop a prototype that can be realized by a small team in a short timeframe.



Thomas Gervraud
Blobfish, Brotato



Philomena Schwab
Stray Fawn



Maxim Munnig Schmidt
Flying Squirrel Entertainment

At the time of writing this application, the game is a prototype containing the basic mechanics and a general feel for the visuals of the game.

Thanks to the bootcamp and frequent private and public testing, we are confident that in its core, the game is appealing and fun to play.

Pre-Production

The pre-production phase starts from December 2026 and is planned to last five months in total. Our goal for the pre-production phase is to create a demo/vertical slice of the game, which we can release on Steam. These are the points we will need to develop further to reach that goal:

Strategic depth: The main thing the game is currently lacking is strategic depth. We will add additional items and weapons and possibilities to interact with them, like for example merging of items or upgrading weapons.

Enemy types: More and different types of enemies will also help to give the game more depth. We also want to give the player the possibility to manipulate which Vampire boss they will face.

UI: The UI is currently made out of placeholder images. We will add a simple but appealing UI, that fits the fantasy and is easy to understand and to handle.

Implement of the Story: We think the world building and fantasy of the game is strong. So we want to use that as our advantage and add more specific story parts. This doesn't mean we implement crazy cutscenes or anything. But, we will add some flavor text at the start of the game and give the boss different dialogues if you meet them.

Production

The production phase is planned to last another 5 months from May to November 2027. In the production phase the focus is on filling the game with content, more items, more bosses and polishing the experience. In addition to that the game will require localization and porting to mobile. The production phase will end with the game being ready for Early Access or Full Release, depending on which release strategy we end up choosing (see [Release and Pricing Strategy](#))

Community Involvement in our development process

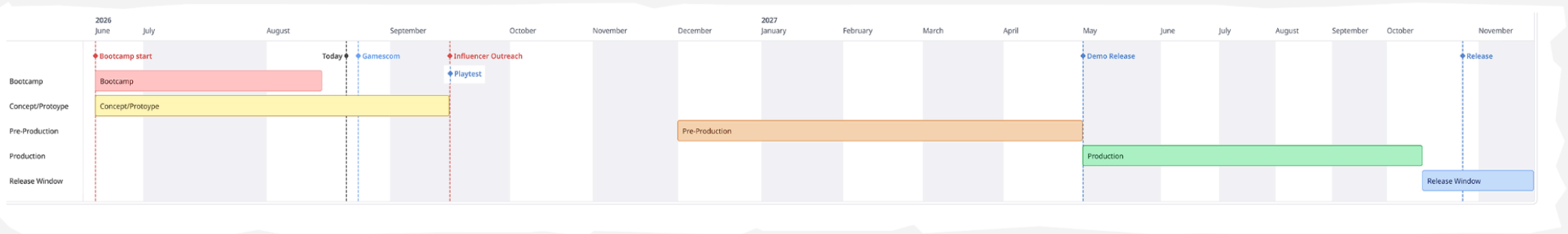
During the pre-production we will also put a big focus on playtesting the game frequently via Steam Playtests to ensure the game goes in the right direction and that we can address players' pain points early on and deliver the best possible product.

By doing playtests we can additionally start growing a discord server and build a community around the game. We can jump start the community a bit with our previous games' community (3700 Members on Discord, 2000 on QQ).

Production Timeline

Key Milestones:

- September 2026: first influencer outreach with our prototype and the other Bootcamp Games to get an initial validation
- December 2026–May 2027: Pre-Production with Demo Release
- May 2027–November 2027: Production ending in the Release Window



Helsing's Revolver Production Timeline

Commercialisation and Market Position

Our game features fast gameplay with a low entry barrier to pick it up. This reflects how we see our game in the market. We have compiled other games and their position in the market and why we believe we can learn from them: (Numbers from gamalytics)

He is coming



Release: 2025
Revenue: ~ \$2M

'He is coming' is our main inspiration regarding a game that is built around item builds and how to make synergies with a small amount of components per build.

Shroom & Gloom



Release: TBA
Wishlists: ~100'000

We are going in a similar direction of visual style like "shroom & gloom". If their game gets released at a similar time, we can hopefully ride on their success. Because our game looks similar but has different mechanics.

Ring of Pain



Release: 2020
Revenue: ~ \$1.2M

'Ring of Pain' is a game with minimal input and clever decision-making that is presented to the player. It is very different in theme but close in its gameplay and strategic depth.

Forward: Escape the Fold



Release: 2022
Revenue: ~ \$210'000

'Forward: Escape the fold' is also a rogue-like about going forward and deciding out of 2-3 options of which enemy you wish to fight or what event you wish to choose. It has a similar strategic depth that we wish to achieve.

Target Audience

Helsing's Revolver is designed for players who enjoy rogue-like about item builds. The game will appeal to those who like a dark vampire setting and interesting world building and trying out different crazy builds to beat the boss all over again. The game is perfect to play on a second screen.

- People with enthusiasm for trying out different item builds
- People who enjoy playing turn based Rogue-like
- People who like Vampires or a wild west setting



Casual Players

Easy to pick up, short sessions, quick gratification

Play titles: Ring of Pain, Dungeon Crawler, Slots and Daggers

Need: Accessibility, simple and smooth inputs, turnbased

Challenged by: no adjustable difficulties, high input gameplay



Experimenter

challenging gameplay, exploration of builds, fast and smooth input

Play titles: He is coming, 9 Kings, Slay the Spire

Need: Variability and depth in builds, exploitation of the systems, replayability

Challenged by: Limited content, shallow item builds, no increase in difficulty



Narrative-Explorer

Story discovery, atmospheric gameplay, exploration of worldbuilding

Play titles: Loop Hero, Darkest Dungeon, Forward: Escape the fold

Need: Rich atmosphere, deep worldbuilding, appealing graphics

Challenged by: flat storytelling, shallow worldbuilding

Target Platform

As we did for our previous game, we will release Helsing's Revolver for Steam (PC/Mac/Linux) and Mobile (Android/iOS). We plan to have the game be playable in vertical mode for mobile, making it easier to pick up and put down on the phone.

Consoles (Switch/Switch 2/XBOX XS/PS) will be taken into consideration after the release on Steam and based on the reception on Steam, we judge whether console ports are a good investment.

Release and Pricing Strategy

Based on this research, we see the following numbers for “Helsing’s Revolver”.

The release strategy for “Helsing’s Revolver” consists of a first Early Access Release and then a full release. We had a good experience releasing into early access with Goblin Sushi and consider repeating this. Especially with the addition of the recently added Personal Calendar on Steam, having an early access and a full release may come to our advantage for getting more reach.

However since this is a new feature on Steam, we are also considering only do a full release, if steam were to change the ability to appear twice in the Personal Calendar.

The pricing for the game depends heavily on the total content of the game and the state in which we release it. The goal is to reach a content target that we can sell the game for \$19.99, as many other games in the genre are selling at this price. But depending on the success of the demo (see in the next section), the development may be shorter and thus the content less, meaning we release a smaller game with a smaller price tag like for example \$9.99.

Sales Predictions are based on our previous games sales (Goblin Sushi).

Revenue	Lower End Sales Low Price	Lower End Sales Low Price	Realistic Sales Lower Price	Realistic Sales Higher Price
Copies Sold	25000	25000	80000	80000
Price	CHF9.99	CHF19.99	CHF9.99	CHF19.99
Average Discount	25.00%	25.00%	25.00%	25.00%
Average Discounted Price	CHF7.49	CHF14.99	CHF7.49	CHF14.99
Approximate Gross Revenue	CHF187,313	CHF374,813	CHF599,400	CHF1,199,400
Steam Cut	30.00%	30.00%	30.00%	30.00%
Approximate Gross Revenue - Steam Cut	CHF131,119	CHF262,369	CHF419,580	CHF839,580

Communication and Distribution Strategy

The mentors of the Swiss Game Hub bootcamp stressed that the choice of genre and the scope of the project are two extremely important aspects when it comes to making a commercially successful indie game.

- **Choice of genre:** Roguelike/Roguelite Deckbuilders are very popular on Steam in general, and we already have experience creating games like this (Goblin Sushi). With the twist of one screen gameplay and dungeon crawler like fighting we tap in a new subgenre. Our main inspiration games like ‘He is coming’ and ‘Shroom and Gloom’ got either released this year or aren’t even out yet. So we have good chances to ride on that wave.

- **Scope of the project:** Making smaller games is less expensive and therefore a much less financial risk. For ‘Helsing’s Revolver’ we aim for a development time of 12-16 months. With the total length of development heavily depending on the perception of the demo.

Apart from these early and impactful decisions, the further marketing plan for Helsing's Revolver includes:

- **Steam Playtest:** We will make a first bigger public validation in September by launching a Playtest on Steam with a small Influencer outreach, supported by the bootcamp.
- **Discord-Community & QQ-Channel:** We had great experience having a Discord server for our game, so we will open one up for Helsing Revolver. To give people the chance to give us direct feedback for the playtest and later the demo. In return we make giveaways and give them insights into the development process. We also have a QQ-Channel and QQ-Group for our games, which gives us the same options as in Discord but for the Chinese audience.
- **Free Demo:** The demo is a very important part in our development process. It's the last step in the validation process, If the demo doesn't get traction the game will not sell. We will focus our main marketing push around this release.
- **Content Creators:** During the Swiss Game Hub's bootcamp we have already created a list of content creators who are known for playing similar games. We first start to reach out to smaller influencers during the playtest and make a bigger influencer push for the demo release.
- **Steam Festivals:** We will participate in different Steam festivals to gather additional wishlists. For example the Steam Deckbuilding Fest. We will also join a Steam Next Fest, close to the full game launch.
- **Social Media:** We will share the game on various social-media platforms (TikTok, 小红书, Instagram, Bluesky, Reddit), concentrating on the big milestones. For our last game we had a lot of success posting on chinese socials such as 小红书 (Rednote) and BiliBili, so we hope that we can reach that audience again. We also believe the chosen genre and setting for "Helsing's Revolver" game can do well in the Chinese market.
- **Cross promotion:** We will reach out to other developers, who make similar games, for possible cross promotion, like Key give-aways in their Discord. This tactic has turned out to be very effective, because you can tap in an already existing community that has a higher chance of being interested in your game.

Financing Plan

This section outlines the financing plan for Helsing's Revolver, including the funding sources to be approached and the projected expenses. It provides an overview of funds and costs, followed by a detailed breakdown for each development phase, with a particular focus on Pre-Production.

Overview

Funds		Expenses	
Studio	CHF172,000	FTE	2.5
Pro Helvetia	CHF20,000	Employee Cost (Salary, etc.)	CHF5,400
		Studio Cost Per Month	CHF500
		Rent	CHF500
		Total Production Time in Months	12
Total	CHF192,000	Total Studio Cost	CHF168,000
		Marketing	CHF15,000
		Localization	CHF4,000
		Freelance Partners (Music)	CHF5,000
		Other Total	CHF24,000
		Total	CHF192,000

Detailed

Prototype Phase

Months	2	
	Employee (Salary+Insurances, etc.)	CHF27,000.00
Studio Cost	Rent	CHF1,000.00
Expenses		CHF28,000.00
<i>Covered by Studio</i>		CHF28,000.00
EBIT		CHF0.00

Pre-Production

Months	5	
	Employee (Salary+Insurances, etc.)	CHF67,500.00
Studio Cost	Rent	CHF2,500.00
Total Studio Cost		CHF70,000.00
Music (Freelance Partner)		CHF1,000.00
Expenses		CHF71,000.00
<i>Pro Helvetia Grant</i>		CHF20,000.00
<i>Covered by Studio</i>		CHF51,000.00
EBIT		CHF0.00

Production

Months	5	
	Employee (Salary+Insurances, etc.)	CHF67,500.00
Studio Cost	Rent	CHF2,500.00
Total Studio Cost		CHF70,000.00
Music (Freelance Partner)		CHF4,000.00
Marketing	Influencer Outreach etc.	CHF15,000.00
Localization		CHF4,000.00
Expenses		CHF93,000.00
<i>Covered by Studio</i>		CHF93,000.00
EBIT		CHF0.00

Social Channels

Website: <https://oldcakefactory.games/>

BlueSky: <https://bsky.app/profile/oldcakefactory.bsky.social>

Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/oldcakefactorygames/>

Tiktok: <https://www.tiktok.com/@oldcakefactory>

Youtube: <https://www.youtube.com/@oldcakefactory>

小红书: <https://www.xiaohongshu.com/user/profile/65d5b5be000000000401e5a6>

Thank you!

Thank you very much for considering the application!

If you have any questions, feel free to reach out: contact@oldcakefactory.games

